SkillNavora

MODULE 9 HANDBOOK

Module 9: AI Product Management, Business Thinking and Adoption

7 sections, every topic explained with how it works, examples and resources.

From Non-Coder to Enterprise AI Builder: Learn, Build, Deploy, Get Hired and Launch Your AI Business.

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Financial figures are hypothetical examples, not advice.

Module 9: AI Product Management, Business Thinking and Adoption

Every section below explains the concept, how it works, each listed topic in detail, a worked example and where to learn more.

Sections

1. 9.1 Business Problem Discovery
2. 9.2 AI Opportunity Identification
3. 9.3 Product Management
4. 9.4 AI Product Management
5. 9.5 Product Adoption
6. 9.6 Business Impact and ROI
7. 9.7 Product and Analytics Tools

MODULE 9 · SECTION 9.1

9.1 Business Problem Discovery

DEFINITION

> Problem discovery finds and validates the real problem before anything is built, using research with the people who have it.

HOW IT WORKS

- Interview users about past behaviour (what happened last time), not opinions about the future.
- Write a problem statement: who, what pain, how often, what it costs now.
- Jobs to Be Done asks what the customer is trying to get done; journey and process maps show each step and where time or errors pile up.
- Root-cause analysis (5 Whys, fishbone) separates symptoms from causes.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Customer discovery, user research, customer interviews, pain points. Customer discovery learns about the customer's world before proposing a solution. User research uses interviews, observation and data. Customer interviews ask about real past experiences ('tell me about the last time...'). Pain points are the frictions, delays, costs and risks users experience.

Problem statements, Jobs to Be Done, personas, customer journeys, process mapping, root cause analysis. A problem statement says who has the problem, what it is, its impact and how it is measured. Jobs to Be Done frames what the user is trying to accomplish. Personas summarise user types. Customer journeys map each stage of their experience. Process mapping documents current steps (as-is) and proposed steps (to-be). Root cause analysis (5 Whys, fishbone) finds why the problem happens.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Interviews show agents spend 3 hours a day re-typing enquiries from WhatsApp into the CRM; that is the problem, not 'we need a chatbot'.

RESOURCES

- Strategyzer: Jobs to be done https://www.strategyzer.com/library/the-value-proposition-canvas
- Teresa Torres: continuous discovery https://www.producttalk.org/

9.2 AI Opportunity Identification

DEFINITION

> AI opportunity identification decides where AI will create value, is feasible with the data available, and is safer or cheaper than the alternatives.

HOW IT WORKS

- Good AI tasks are high-volume, language- or judgement-heavy, tolerant of small errors, and have data or documents available.
- Check feasibility: data access, quality, privacy limits, needed accuracy, latency and cost per task.
- Build vs buy: buy when a product already solves it; build when the workflow or data is unique.
- Prioritise by value × feasibility ÷ risk.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

AI use-case and automation discovery; feasibility; data availability; model suitability. AI use-case discovery lists tasks that involve reading, writing, classifying, extracting, summarising, answering or deciding at volume. Automation discovery finds repetitive rule-based steps. Feasibility checks technical possibility; data availability checks the data exists and can be accessed legally; model suitability checks a model can do the task to the needed accuracy.

Build vs buy; AI vs traditional software; risk assessment; prioritisation. Build vs buy: buy an existing tool when it fits; build when the workflow, data or integration is unique or core. AI vs traditional software: use plain rules when they are reliable and explainable; use AI for language and judgement. Risk assessment covers wrong outputs, privacy, bias and regulation. Prioritisation ranks by value, effort and risk (RICE or impact/effort matrix).

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Invoice data extraction scores high (high volume, clear rules, measurable accuracy); automated credit decisions score low (high risk, regulation).

RESOURCES

- Google: People + AI Guidebook https://pair.withgoogle.com/guidebook/
- Microsoft: guidelines for human-AI interaction https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/research/project/guidelines-for-human-ai-interaction/

9.3 Product Management

DEFINITION

> Product management decides what to build, for whom and why, and guides the team from vision to launch and iteration.

HOW IT WORKS

- Vision (where we are going), strategy (how we win), roadmap (sequence of outcomes).
- A PRD states the problem, users, goals, scope, requirements and success metrics; a BRD states the business need; user stories describe value from the user's view with acceptance criteria.
- An MVP is the smallest product that tests the riskiest assumption with real users.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Product vision, strategy, roadmap and lifecycle. Product vision: the long-term change the product makes. Strategy: where and how it will win. Roadmap: the planned sequence of outcomes and features. Product lifecycle: introduction, growth, maturity, decline.

PRD, BRD, technical specifications, user stories, acceptance criteria. PRD (product requirements document): problem, users, goals, requirements, metrics, scope. BRD (business requirements document): business need, objectives, stakeholders, benefits. Technical specification: how engineers will build it. User stories ('As a..., I want..., so that...') with acceptance criteria (Given/When/Then).

Agile, Scrum, Kanban, backlog management, MVP, prototyping, product discovery. Agile, Scrum and Kanban organise delivery. Backlog management keeps a prioritised, refined list of work. MVP (minimum viable product) tests the core value with the least effort. Prototyping uses clickable designs or quick builds. Product discovery validates value, usability, feasibility and viability before full build.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> User story: As a sales agent, I want new WhatsApp leads in the CRM automatically so I can call them within 5 minutes. Acceptance: lead appears within 60 seconds with name, phone and message.

RESOURCES

- Atlassian: product management guide https://www.atlassian.com/agile/product-management
- SkillNavora PRD library https://skillnavora.in/prd-library.html

9.4 AI Product Management

DEFINITION

> AI product management adds model choice, data, evaluation, uncertainty and human oversight to normal product work.

HOW IT WORKS

- Requirements include quality targets (for example 95% extraction accuracy), latency, cost per task and failure handling.
- Define the evaluation set before building; quality is measured, not assumed.
- Design the UX for uncertainty: show sources, confidence and easy correction; keep a human in the loop for risky actions.
- Iterate on prompts, retrieval and models with the evaluation set as the guard.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

AI product lifecycle and architecture; model selection. The AI product lifecycle adds data collection, model selection, evaluation and monitoring to the normal lifecycle. AI product architecture shows the model, prompts, retrieval, tools, guardrails and feedback loop. Model selection balances quality, cost, latency and data rules.

AI requirements; prompt and context requirements; model evaluation; AI quality metrics. AI requirements specify quality targets, allowed error rates, latency and cost budgets. Prompt and context requirements specify instructions, knowledge sources and tone. Model evaluation uses a test set and rubric. AI quality metrics include accuracy, groundedness, task success and user acceptance rate.

Human oversight, AI UX, responsible AI, AI product iteration. Human oversight defines when people review or approve. AI UX shows sources, confidence and editability, and sets expectations about errors. Responsible AI covers fairness, transparency, privacy and safety. AI product iteration improves prompts, data and models using evaluation results and user feedback.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> An AI summary feature ships only after reaching 90% rubric score on 300 real tickets, with a 'report a wrong summary' button feeding the next evaluation set.

RESOURCES

- Google: People + AI Guidebook https://pair.withgoogle.com/guidebook/
- SkillNavora: AI evals for PMs https://skillnavora.in/ai-evals.html

9.5 Product Adoption

DEFINITION

> Adoption is whether people actually use the product and keep using it. Deployment without adoption creates no value.

HOW IT WORKS

- Track activation (first value), adoption (share of target users active), retention and feature usage.
- Onboarding, training and in-app guidance remove first-use friction; change management explains why and what changes for each role.
- Feedback loops capture complaints and corrections and feed them into the backlog.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Onboarding, activation, adoption metrics, retention, engagement, feature adoption. Onboarding guides users to their first success. Activation is the moment users first get value. Adoption metrics: active users, feature usage, frequency. Retention: users still active after 30/90 days. Engagement: depth of use. Feature adoption: share of users using a specific feature.

Customer success, feedback loops, product analytics, change management, training, enablement. Customer success teams help accounts achieve outcomes. Feedback loops capture ratings, comments and corrections. Product analytics measure behaviour. Change management helps people accept new ways of working. Training and enablement give users and champions the skills and materials they need.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Only 20% of agents use the AI reply tool; interviews show it is three clicks away. Moving it into the ticket view lifts usage to 70%.

RESOURCES

- Mixpanel: product analytics guides https://mixpanel.com/blog/
- Prosci: change management (ADKAR) https://www.prosci.com/methodology/adkar

9.6 Business Impact and ROI

DEFINITION

> Business impact shows what the solution changes in money, time, risk or revenue. ROI compares that gain with total cost.

HOW IT WORKS

- ROI = (benefit − cost) ÷ cost. Total cost of ownership includes build, model usage, cloud, support and change management.
- Measure a baseline before launch, then the same metric after.
- Payback period = cost ÷ monthly benefit. Use clearly labelled assumptions; never present estimates as guarantees.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Business cases; cost-benefit analysis; ROI; TCO. A business case justifies an investment with benefits, costs, risks and alternatives. Cost-benefit analysis compares them in money. ROI = (benefit − cost) ÷ cost. TCO (total cost of ownership) includes build, licences, model usage, cloud, support, training and maintenance over several years.

Productivity, process efficiency, cost savings, revenue opportunities, automation payback, KPIs. Productivity improvement: more output per person-hour. Process efficiency: shorter cycle time and fewer errors. Cost savings: lower spending. Revenue opportunities: more conversions or new offerings. Automation payback period: months until savings repay the investment. KPIs measure progress (response time, accuracy, cost per case). Label estimates as estimates and state assumptions.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> Hypothetical: 10 agents save 2 hours a day at $15/hour → $6,000 a month. Cost $2,500 build + $400/month run → payback in under 1 month.

RESOURCES

- Harvard Business School Online: ROI https://online.hbs.edu/blog/post/how-to-calculate-roi-for-a-project
- Investopedia: total cost of ownership https://www.investopedia.com/terms/t/totalcostofownership.asp

9.7 Product and Analytics Tools

DEFINITION

> These are the everyday tools for planning, designing, documenting and measuring products.

HOW IT WORKS

- Jira tracks work items and sprints; Confluence holds documents; Figma and FigJam design screens and run workshops; Miro is a whiteboard.
- Postman tests APIs; Power BI builds dashboards; Mixpanel and Google Analytics track user behaviour.
- Pick one tool per job and keep a single source of truth.

EVERY TOPIC EXPLAINED

Jira, Figma, FigJam, Postman, Power BI, Mixpanel, Google Analytics, Confluence, Miro. Jira: issue and sprint tracking. Figma: interface design and prototypes. FigJam: collaborative whiteboard for workshops and flows. Postman: API testing. Power BI: dashboards and business reports. Mixpanel: product event analytics and funnels. Google Analytics: website traffic and conversions. Confluence: team documentation. Miro: visual collaboration boards for mapping and planning.

WORKED EXAMPLE

> A discovery workshop runs in FigJam, the PRD lives in Confluence, the stories are in Jira, and adoption is tracked in Mixpanel.

RESOURCES

- Jira documentation https://support.atlassian.com/jira-software-cloud/
- Figma help https://help.figma.com/